Andrew D. Crena

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EDUCATION

California State University, Chico - Chico, CA | B.A., Psychology**,** *May 2022*
Postgraduate coursework (non-degree): Psychology, University of Pittsburgh (2022-2023); Statistics, Community College of Allegheny County (2023).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Lab Manager | Study Coordinator, *June 2024 – Sep 2026*
Stanford University Mind & Body Lab | PI: Dr. Alia Crum, Stanford, CA - Full-time
Study Coordinator, EMBRACE Study (NCT06705218)

- Coordinated day-to-day operations of a nationwide, fully decentralized R01 randomized controlled trial testing a digital mindset intervention in newly diagnosed cancer patients, from recruitment through data collection across 444 participants and five longitudinal timepoints.
- Developed and authored study SOPs (recruitment, biospecimen collection, participant tracking); built the trial's REDCap instruments, implemented study materials on the participant-facing platform, and maintained PHI-compliant data systems.
- Led community-facing recruitment across a nationally distributed patient population, partnering with and presenting to cancer support organizations and patient-advocacy networks to reach eligible participants.
- Set up and ran the at-home biomarker pipeline for 2,400 Tasso-M20 dried blood spot kits: distribution, return logistics, processing, and -80°C storage for downstream inflammatory-marker assay; directly managed rotating groups of 3–6 RAs under BSL-1 protocol.
- Recruited, trained, and supervised approximately 20 undergraduate research assistants over two years, responsible for high-volume biospecimen processing in the wet lab and participant messaging through the study's custom chat platform; ran weekly team meetings, drafted sections of annual NIH progress reports (RPPR), and assisted with IRB protocol and amendment submissions.

Lab Manager

- Supported preparation and launch of a doctoral researcher's digital yoga-based stress-mindset study in a bar-exam-taker sample, adapting the lab's decentralized study-platform framework for a new intervention and participant population. Worked closely with the researcher and web-development team to implement study content and remote delivery.
- Created a comprehensive study-platform manual documenting reusable workflows for participant payments, biospecimen logistics, REDCap scheduling, platform content, and study administration to support future decentralized studies in the lab. Ran day-to-day lab operations: meetings and events, visiting scholars, onboarding, purchasing and reimbursements, and lab website upkeep; served as EH&S liaison for biohazardous waste disposal and safety documentation.

Affiliated Researcher, *Aug 2026 – Present*
ETH Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland | Interventions for Promoting Effective Uncertainty Regulation (SNSF grant no. 207691)

- Contributing to a multi-arm study of brief digital well-being interventions, supporting design decisions around intervention delivery and timing, and assisting in the development of a digitally based breathwork condition.

Research Assistant (Post-Baccalaureate), *May 2023 – May 2024*
San Diego State University - San Diego, CA - Volunteer, 20 hrs/week | TEND Lab | PI: Dr. Jillian Lee Wiggins

- Performed R data cleaning and exploratory analysis (Excel, Google Sheets, REDCap) for an R01 fMRI study and assisted with fMRI preprocessing and QC in Linux, AFNI, and MATLAB; supported longitudinal data collection (mock-scan sessions, experimental stimuli, caregiver consent, assessments with 5–8-year-old participants, RA training).

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Laboratory Technician I, *May 2022 – Apr 2023*
University of Pittsburgh Medical Center, Division of Laboratory Animal Resources (DLAR) - Full-time

- Provided animal husbandry and daily health observations across species; oversaw breeding/weaning for immunocompromised and biohazardous strains and maintained sterilization and safety logs.

Recovery Coach, *May 2023 – June 2024*
Crestwood Behavioral Health, Inc. - San Diego, CA - Full-time
- Provided one-on-one support to a caseload of five clients with co-occurring mental health and substance-use challenges in a 20-person inpatient program; ran medication pass and kept detailed documentation of client interactions, medication adherence, and program events.
- Planned and ran breathwork meditation and focus groups, and took groups out to community activities, including bonfires, movies, and shopping trips.

TEACHING, MENTORSHIP & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Teaching Assistant, PSYCH 20N: How Beliefs Create Reality, *Spring 2026*
Stanford University - Stanford, CA | Instructor: Dr. Alia Crum
- Ran small discussion groups during each session of weekly seminar on how mindsets and expectations shape health, performance, and well-being, and prepared class materials.

Research Mentor, Stanford PsychSummer Program, *Summer 2024 & 2025*
- Mentored undergraduate researchers through the Stanford Undergraduate Psychology Association (SUPA) across two summers, guiding project conceptualization and best practices in data management and statistical analysis in R.

Volunteer, Center for Creativity, *Sep 2026 – Present*
- Planning improvements to public-facing digital resources and internal administrative systems supporting private events, community workshops, youth performing arts, and other center programming.
- Preparing to contribute across visitor engagement, including in-person docent duties, community outreach, and grant writing as the volunteer role develops.

Youth Program Lead, WorkED, *San Diego, CA, June – July 2023*
- Developed and taught a three-week business and game-design curriculum to twenty 7th–8th graders from underrepresented backgrounds, culminating in a final project using Python, Canva, and Google Slides.

Founder, 'Music for Mental Health' Fundraising Initiative, *Chico, CA*, *July 2021 – Apr 2023*
- Founded a student-led music and mental-health fundraising project at CSU, Chico that raised over $5,000 for local nonprofits through annual community events, including Sandypalooza. Mobilized student DJs, local businesses, venues, and nonprofit partners, including NAMI Yolo County and the Boys & Girls Club of North Valley, while giving emerging student musicians and DJs a platform.

Volunteer Archivist, Archive Project, Johns Hopkins University, *Aug 2026 – Present*
- Contributing as a volunteer archivist to the Archive Project in Dr. David Yaden's lab.

Volunteer Tutor, Project READ, *Redwood City Public Library Jan 2026 – Present*
- Completed multi-session tutor training; meet weekly with a matched ESL learner to practice reading, writing, and conversation built around the learner's goals.

Volunteer Science Educator, Brain Day, *Stanford Neuroscience Outreach***,** *Mar 2025 – Mar 2026*
- Visit local middle-school classrooms each year with Stanford School of Medicine researchers, leading hands-on demonstrations with preserved human and animal brains and sharing paths into research.

Volunteer Vinyl DJ, *Stanford Jazz Workshop & local community events 2025 – Present*
- Set up and play records for local Redwood City cafes and events and, notably, during the Stanford Jazz Festival.

GRANTS & FUNDED PROJECTS

2024–2025 (x2) **Grant**. Stanford University Department of Psychology Infrastructure Fund, *EMBRACE Study*. Project contributor: lab management, study coordination, and web design & development; **$100,000 total**

CONFERENCE POSTERS

Gasteiger, C., **Crena, A. D.**, Pagador, K., Jiang, T., Zion, S., Jo, B., Slavich, G. M., Spiegel, D., Steele, N., Berek, J. S., Shapira, L., & Crum, A. J. (2025, November). *Changing mindsets to improve whole-person health: A decentralized randomized trial of a novel digital intervention* [Poster session]. Joint Meeting of the Clinical Oncology Society of Australia and the International Psycho-Oncology Society, Adelaide, Australia.

SKILLS, CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

Research operations: Clinical-trial coordination, recruitment and retention, informed consent, questionnaire administration, IRB submissions and amendments, GCP, HIPAA/PHI, SOP development, QA/QC, participant scheduling, and group-program logistics.

Data and software: Proficient in R, Microsoft Office, REDCap, Qualtrics, PHI-compliant file systems, Canva, Google Sheets, WordPress, SPSS; familiar with AFNI, UNIX, MATLAB, Python

Training: Stanford Human Subjects Protection; Good Clinical Practice for Social and Behavioral Research; HIPAA/PHI; Biosafety; Bloodborne Pathogens; MRI safety

Memberships: Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP); Association for Psychological Science (APS).